going to the mountain, Golwalkar wrote: 'In the Indian situation, the Hindu is the mountain, and the Muslim population, Mohammed. I need not elaborate.'[26] A few paragraphs earlier I have quoted his approving words about Nazi theories of race. There is more in his writing that is even more chilling.

Golwalkar's hatred for non-Hindus was especially virulent when it came to Muslims and Christians; he regarded Parsis and Jews in India as model minorities who knew their place and did not ruffle any Hindu feathers. In his pungent view: '[H]ere was already a full-fledged ancient nation of the Hindus and the various communities which were living in the country were here either as guests, the Jews and Parsis, or as invaders, the Muslims and Christians.'[27] He added: 'They never faced the question how all such heterogenous groups could be called as children of the soil merely because, by an accident, they happened to reside in a common territory under the rule of a common enemy.'

Golwalkar strongly opposed all talk of a secular Indian state. As he wrote in *We, or Our Nationhood Defined*:

> 'There are only two courses open to these foreign elements', Golwalkar went on, 'either to merge themselves in the national race and adopt its culture or to live at its mercy so long as the national race may allow them to do so and quit the country at the sweet will of the national race. That is the only sound view on the minorities' problem… [The] foreign races in Hindusthan must either adopt the Hindu culture and language, must learn to respect and hold in reverence Hindu religion, must entertain no idea but those of the glorification of the Hindu race and culture, i.e., of the Hindu nation and must lose their separate existence to merge in the Hindu race, or may stay in the country, wholly subordinated to the Hindu Nation, claiming nothing, deserving no privileges, far less any preferential treatment—not even citizen's rights.'[28]

Golwalkar acknowledged the reality of diversity within Hinduism, but argued that Hindus shared 'the same philosophy of life', 'the same goal' and 'the same holy samskaras',[29] which therefore formed a strong cultural and a civilisational basis for a nation. These values, aspirations and philosophy were not, however, in his view, shared by Muslims and Christians. Though the proponents of Hindutva would not welcome the comparison, Golwalkar's conception of Hindu India is not so very different from the prevailing ideology of a Muslim Pakistan.

While Hindutva has tended to reserve most of its virulence for Muslims, Golwalkar was openly suspicious of Christians too. In *Bunch*